Creator Signals

LEARN · GROW · EARN

FREE DOWNLOAD

Creator Starter Kit.

Start creating with a clear plan. A practical workbook for your first week as a TikTok creator.

- Niche worksheet
- 10 hook formulas
- Script template
- 7-day planner
- Analytics tracker
- Weekly review

Version 1.1 · November 2026 · creatorsignals.blog

WELCOME

Stop guessing. Start creating.

This kit helps you go from "I want to start" to a clear plan and your first published videos — in about one week.

How to use this kit

1. **Work through the pages in order.** Each page has a short explanation and an exercise.
2. **Fill it in digitally or print it.** All boxes are fillable in a PDF reader (e.g. Adobe Acrobat Reader, Preview or your browser). Save the file after typing.
3. **Publish, measure, reflect.** The last pages help you track your first 7 videos and learn from them.

The Creator Signals Method

Everything we teach follows five steps. You'll use all of them in this kit.

Learn	Create	Test	Analyse	Improve

What's inside

01	How TikTok discovery works — the honest version	p. 3
02	Your creator why & niche	p. 4
03	Know your audience	p. 5
04	Your 3 content pillars	p. 6
05	10 hook formulas	p. 7
06	Write your own hooks	p. 8
07	Simple video script	p. 9
08	7-day content plan	p. 10
09	Analytics basics	p. 11
10	7-video tracker & weekly review	p. 12–13

01 · LEARN

How discovery works — the honest version.

Nobody outside TikTok knows the exact formula, and it changes over time. Anyone who promises "the secret algorithm hack" is guessing. What we *do* know is enough to start well.

What TikTok says it looks at

In its own public explanations, TikTok says the For You feed is personalised using signals such as:

- **How people interact** with videos — for example watching, rewatching, liking, sharing, commenting or skipping.
- **Information in the video** — such as captions, sounds and topics.
- **Settings** — like language and country, which help decide who might be interested.

Check TikTok's own Creator Academy and help pages for the latest details — platforms update their explanations regularly.

What this means for you

Focus on

- A clear opening that tells viewers why to stay
- One topic per video
- Content for a specific audience
- Consistency you can keep up

Ignore

- "Magic" hashtags that guarantee reach
- One perfect posting time for everyone
- Shadowban rumours without evidence
- Promises of going viral

Signal, not proof. One video doing well (or badly) tells you very little. Patterns across several videos tell you a lot. That's why this kit makes you track 7.

02 · CREATE

Your creator why & niche.

A niche is not a cage. It's a promise: "if you follow me, you'll get *this*." Start focused — you can widen later.

Why do I want to create content? (What do I want to get out of it?)

Niche finder

Write down three possible niches. Score each from 1 (low) to 5 (high).

POSSIBLE NICHE	I ENJOY IT	I KNOW A BIT	PEOPLE SEARCH IT	I CAN POST WEEKLY

Tip for "people search it": type the topic into TikTok's search bar and look at the suggestions and existing videos.

My chosen niche (for the next 30 days)

My one-sentence promise: "I help ___ with ___ so they can ___."

02 · CREATE

Know your audience.

Picture one real type of person you want to help. Writing for “everyone” usually reaches no one.

Who are they? (stage of life, situation)

What level are they at? (beginner, some experience…)

What problems or questions do they have about my niche? (list 3–5)

What result do they want?

Which words would they type into search?

Which creators do they already watch?

Quick research: read the comments under popular videos in your niche. The questions people ask there are ready-made video ideas.

02 · CREATE

Your 3 content pillars.

Content pillars are the 3 recurring themes of your account. They make planning easy and help viewers know what to expect.

Example — fitness for busy parents: ① 15-minute home workouts ② beginner mistakes & fixes ③ honest progress updates

PILLAR 1

Theme

3 video ideas

PILLAR 2

Theme

3 video ideas

PILLAR 3

Theme

3 video ideas

Profile check

- My username is easy to read and remember
- My bio says who I help and what they get
- My profile photo is clear, even at small size

My new bio (max. ~80 characters)

01 · LEARN

10 hook formulas.

A hook is the first line or moment of your video. It answers the viewer's silent question: "why should I keep watching?" Replace **[topic]** and **[audience]** with your own.

MISTAKE	**"3 mistakes [audience] make with [topic] — and how to fix them."**
HOW-TO	**"How to start with [topic], even as a complete beginner."**
RESULT-FIRST	**"I tried [topic] for 7 days. Here's what changed."**
QUESTION	**"Is [topic] really worth it for [audience]?"**
CURIOSITY	**"The one tip about [topic] I wish I'd known sooner."**
BOLD CLAIM	**"[Topic] is simpler than you think."**
LIST	**"3 things every beginner should know about [topic]."**
STORY	**"The day [topic] finally clicked for me."**
SAVE THIS	**"Save this: a simple checklist for [topic]."**
CONTRAST	**"Everyone says this about [topic]. Here's what I do instead."**

Make the hook true. The rest of the video must deliver what the hook promises. Clickbait that doesn't deliver makes people leave — and stop trusting you.

Write your own hooks.

Pick one video idea from your pillars. Write five different openings for the *same* video. Then choose the two strongest to test.

My video idea

#	HOOK	FORMULA USED
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		

My test

Hook A

Hook B

What I keep the same (topic, length, posting time…)

Need more ideas? The free Hook Builder at **creatorsignals.blog/tools** gives you 10 structures for any topic.

02 · CREATE

Simple video script.

Most short educational videos work well with this five-part structure. Keep each part short — say it out loud and cut what you don't need.

1. **Hook** — the first line. Why should they stay?
2. **Context** — who is this for, what problem?
3. **Value** — the tip, steps or story (the main part).
4. **Proof or example** — show it, demonstrate it, give an example.
5. **Ending** — a simple next step ("save this", "try it today", a question for comments).

Caption (with words people search for)

On-screen text / visuals

7-day content plan.

Plan a week you can actually keep up. Three good videos are better than seven rushed ones — post as often as you can sustain.

DAY	VIDEO IDEA	PILLAR	HOOK	DONE ✓
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

Batch it

- **Plan** all ideas and hooks in one sitting
- **Film** 2–3 videos in one session
- **Edit & schedule** in another session

Prefer planning online? The free 30-Day Content Planner at **creatorsignals.blog/tools/content-planner** saves everything in your browser.

04 · ANALYSE

Analytics basics.

TikTok shows analytics for your videos in the app (the exact names and location can change with app updates). These are the numbers worth understanding first.

Views
How many times the video was played. Shows reach — not whether people liked it.

Average watch time
How long people watched on average. Compare it with the length of your video.

Watched full video / retention
How many viewers stayed until the end, and where they dropped off. A big drop at the start often means the hook can be clearer.

Likes, comments, shares, saves
Shares and saves often mean the content was useful enough to keep or pass on.

New followers
How many people followed after this video — a sign they want more of the same.

Traffic source
Where views came from (e.g. For You, search, your profile). Search views mean your topic and caption match what people look for.

Engagement rate = (likes + comments + shares) ÷ views × 100%
One common definition. Others exist — always use the same one when you compare your own videos.

04 · ANALYSE

7-video tracker.

Fill in each video 2–3 days after posting, so the numbers have time to settle. Compare your videos with *each other*, not with other creators.

#	TOPIC / HOOK	VIEWS	AVG. WATCH	LIKES	COMM.	SHARES	SAVES	ENG. %
1								
2								
3								
4								
5								
6								
7								

Look for patterns

Which video kept people watching longest?

What did the strongest videos have in common?

Calculator: the free Engagement Calculator at **creatorsignals.blog/tools** works out the engagement % and compares two videos for you.

05 · IMPROVE

Weekly review.

Ten minutes of honest reflection is where real improvement happens. Do this at the end of every week.

Videos published

Total views

Hooks tested

✓ What worked this week?

✕ What didn't work — and why might that be?

→ What will I test next week? (one thing at a time)

How do I feel about creating right now? (energy, fun, time)

Be kind to yourself. Small numbers are normal at the start. You're building a skill — the reviews are your proof of progress.

WHAT'S NEXT

Keep the signal going.

You now have a niche, an audience, three pillars, hooks, a script, a plan and a tracker. That's more structure than most creators ever start with.

Free on creatorsignals.blog

- **Hook Builder** — 10 hook ideas for any topic
- **Engagement Calculator** — compare two videos
- **30-Day Content Planner** — plan, log results, weekly reviews, CSV export
- **Free sample lesson** — Day 8: Understanding TikTok hooks

COMING SOON

30-Day Creator Launchpad

30 daily lessons and assignments, a full workbook, content calendar, hook library and analytics tracker — the complete next step after this kit.

creatorsignals.blog/academy

Good to know

Built for creators worldwide. TikTok features are primarily checked using a UK account; availability, names and requirements may vary by country, account type and app version.

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